
User Story Estimation

Software Engineering 2 – Workshop #2

Plan

- Team formation ~30'
 - Recap: how agile teams estimate user stories ~20'
 - BREAK
 - Each team estimate their own stories ~1h'
 - Estimation Poker with Fibonacci
 - With paper, hands, or online
 - Visits to teams for feedback (and absences check)
 - Wrap up ~30'
 - Survey
 - Feedback + Q&A
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THE TEAMS

Team composition

- Composition of the teams has been published online
 - We'll do a role call so that you can find each other
 - Then you have 10 minutes to move around so that you can sit close to each other
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Recap:

ESTIMATION

Effort Estimation

- Essential to define a predictable schedule
 - Relative vs. Absolute estimates
 - Former are much easier
 - Stories are sized in term of “points”
 - Using Fibonacci series
 - After a sprint is complete an estimate of stories per sprint i.e., “velocity” is done
 - Velocity is NOT a performance measure
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Estimation Poker procedure

- **Presentation:** team discusses story requirements, complexities, and possible challenges.
 - **Estimation:** Each team member privately selects a card representing their estimate for the effort.
 - **Reveal:** Estimates are revealed simultaneously.
 - **Discussion:** If difference in estimates, high and low discuss to clarify misunderstandings or discrepancies.
 - **Consensus:** The process is repeated until the team reaches a consensus on the estimated effort.
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Fibonacci Poker Cards



Planning Poker Online

<https://planningpokeronline.com/>



Features Pricing



Sign Up

Login

Start new game

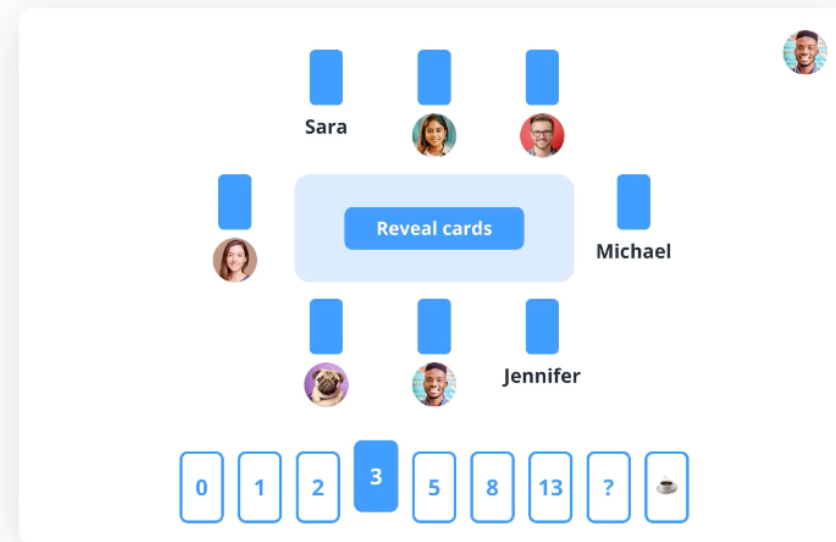
Scrum Poker for agile teams

Easy-to-use and fun estimations.

Start new game

TRUSTED BY TEAMS AT

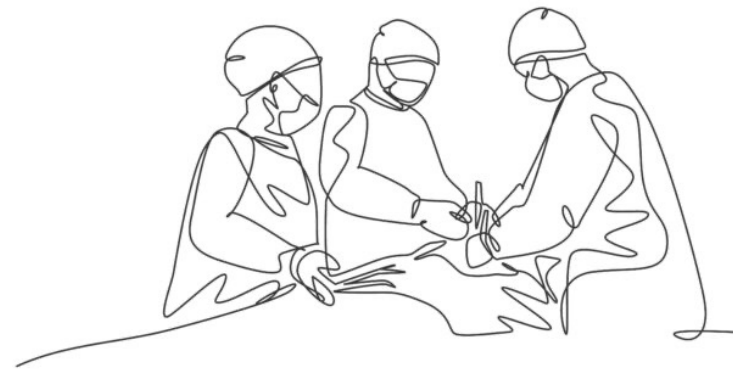
 Microsoft  Google  **Deloitte.** 



It's effort, not complexity



Glue 1,000 stamps



Perform a “simple” brain surgery

It's effort, not complexity

Suppose a team consists of a little kid and a brain surgeon. Their product backlog includes two items: lick 1,000 stamps and perform a simple brain surgery -- snip and done.

These items are chosen to presumably take the same amount of time. If you disagree, simply adjust the number of stamps in the example.

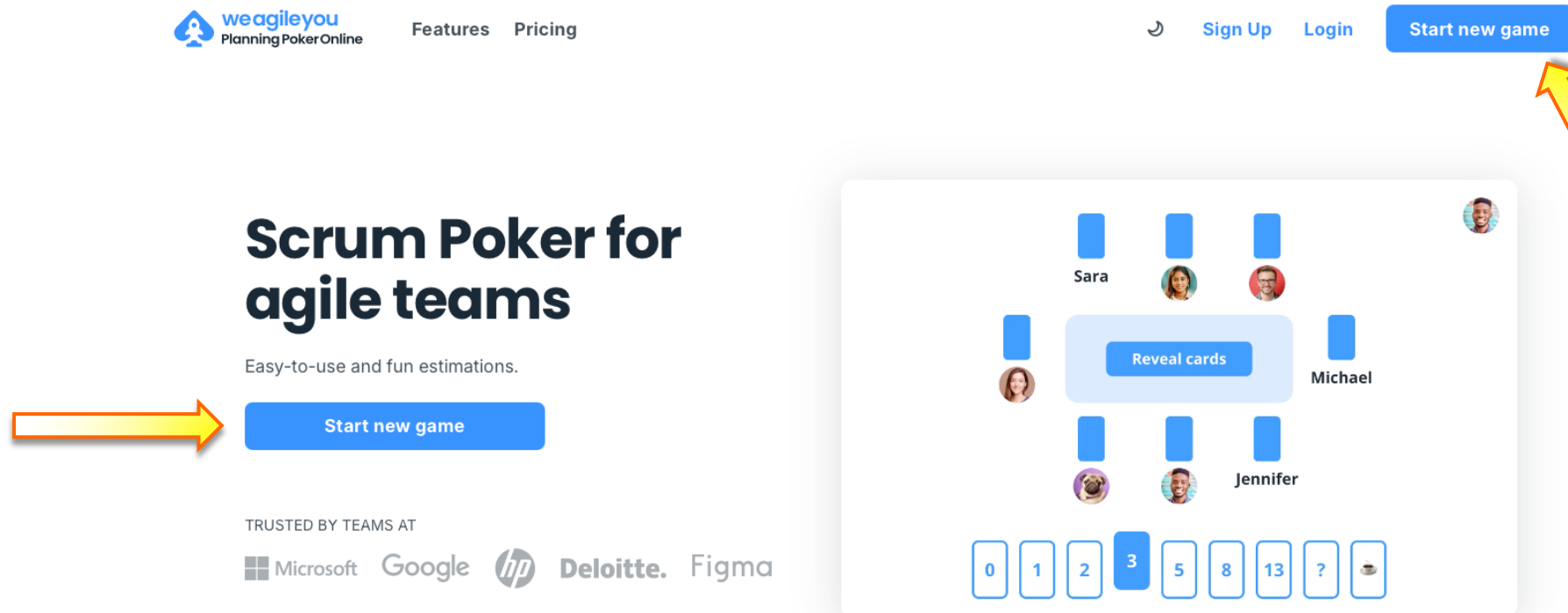
Despite their vastly different complexities, the two items should be given the same number of story points because each is expected to take the same amount of time. In this carefully chosen example, the volume of work (licking 1,000 stamps and one snip to some part of the brain) and the complexity of that work combine such that each will take the same amount of time

(Mike Cohn)

<https://www.mountangoatsoftware.com/blog/its-effort-not-complexity>

Planning Poker Online

<https://planningpokeronline.com/>



The screenshot shows the Planning Poker Online website. The header includes the logo 'weagileyou Planning Poker Online', links for 'Features' and 'Pricing', and buttons for 'Sign Up', 'Login', and 'Start new game'. A yellow arrow points to the 'Start new game' button in the top right. The main content area features the heading 'Scrum Poker for agile teams' and the subtext 'Easy-to-use and fun estimations.' Below this is another 'Start new game' button, which is also highlighted with a yellow arrow. At the bottom, it says 'TRUSTED BY TEAMS AT' followed by logos for Microsoft, Google, HP, Deloitte, and Figma. An inset image shows a game interface with five players (Sara, Michael, Jennifer, and two unnamed) around a table. A central button says 'Reveal cards'. At the bottom of the inset, there is a row of cards with numbers: 0, 1, 2, 3 (highlighted), 5, 8, 13, ?, and a coffee cup icon.

One team member creates the game

Planning Poker Online

Game's name 0

Voting system

Show advanced settings... 1

Create game

Game's name

Voting system

Who can reveal cards

Who can manage issues

Auto-reveal cards ☒

Enable fun features ☒

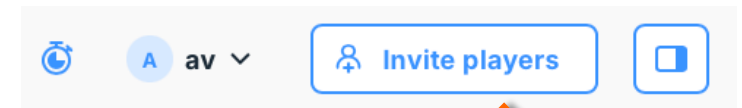
Show average in the results 2 off ☐

Show countdown animation ☒

3 Create game

<https://planningpokeronline.com/>

Planning Poker Online



Feeling lonely? 🙄

[Invite players](#)

Invite other
team members

Pick your cards!



av

Do NOT use 0 !

Choose your card 📌



Do NOT use

To work!

- For every story in your project
 - Perform estimates using estimation poker
 - With online tool <https://planningpokeronline.com/>
 - Use Fibonacci numbers
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FAQ

- Q: should we consider the setup of the system (framework, DB, etc.)?
A: No. The setup is not part of any specific story and should not be included in the story point estimates
 - Q: should a story point correspond to a given number of person hours?
A: No. What is relevant is the **relative** size of stories. Where 1 is the smallest possible story you can imagine. Remember that you don't know the technology you are going to use yet
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FAQ

- Q: Can different user stories have the same estimation ?
 - A: Yes

 - Q: Can I change my estimations ?
 - A: Only during the estimation meeting. It is recommended that you get an overview once you have done all estimations, and in case make adjustments. From that moment, no more changes to the estimations are admitted.

 - Q: Should I take into account other stories in estimating a story?
 - A: No
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Next steps

- Start thinking about the technology
 - Everything should be paperless
 - Homework for next Friday
 - On Friday you will start planning for the sprint
 - Stories will be selected
 - Selected stories will be split into tasks
 - Additional tasks will be added
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